

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Interdisciplinary Political Analysis - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Interdisciplinary Political Analysis

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1

The Integrated Political Question

2

Definitions, Argument Spine and Purposeful Borrowing

3

Boundaries, Thinkers and Disciplinary Autonomy

4

Illustrations and the Five-Discipline Matrix

5

Trap Repair, Cross-Links, Revision and Sources

6

Anthropology, Law and Geography

7

Borrowed Models and Named Reductionisms

8

Objections and Integration Without Merger

9

Cautious Indian Application

10

Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Interdisciplinary Political Analysis - Solved Practice Workbook	3
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	3
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	13
VERIFIED PYQ STATUS	13
ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	13

Interdisciplinary Political Analysis - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g2 **PYQ ownership:** No directly owned verified PYQ is assigned to this topic; all questions below are original practice.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Discipline**?

A. A branch or field of learning. B. Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought. C. Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture. D. studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Discipline** with **A branch or field of learning**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A branch or field of learning**.

A. Aristotle B. Discipline C. David Easton's political-system framework D. Empirical approach

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A branch or field of learning**. with **Discipline**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Interdisciplinary approach**?

A. Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda. B. Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal. C. Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved. D. the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Interdisciplinary approach** with **Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved**.

A. Marx and Engels B. Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model C. Normative approach D. Interdisciplinary approach

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved**. with **Interdisciplinary approach**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Empirical approach**?

A. Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction. B. Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems. C. Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life. D. Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Empirical approach** with **Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.**

A. Heinz Eulau B. Empirical approach C. Economic reductionism D. Political economy

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.** with **Empirical approach.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Normative approach?**

A. Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation. B. political order does not require a Weberian state. C. Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done. D. political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Normative approach** with **Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.**

A. Seymour Martin Lipset B. Discipline C. Political sociology D. Normative approach

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.** with **Normative approach.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political economy?**

A. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions. B. Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict. C. distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained. D. political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political economy** with **Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.**

A. Auguste Comte B. Political economy C. Interdisciplinary approach D. Political psychology

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.** with **Political economy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political sociology**?

A. Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture. B. studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography. C. Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought. D. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political sociology** with **Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.**

A. David Easton's political-system framework B. Empirical approach C. Political philosophy D. Political sociology

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.** with **Political sociology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political psychology**?

A. Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda. B. Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal. C. the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis. D. is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback .

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political psychology** with **Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.**

A. Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model B. Political psychology C. Normative approach D. History

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.** with **Political psychology.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political philosophy**?

A. Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life. B. Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure. C. Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems. D. is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political philosophy** with **Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.**

A. Economic reductionism B. Political economy C. Economics D. Political philosophy

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.** with **Political philosophy.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **History**?

A. Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation. B. political order does not require a Weberian state. C. political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context. D. (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **History** with **Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.**

A. Discipline B. History C. Political sociology D. Sociology

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.** with **History.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Economics**?

A. distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary

evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained. B. political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations. C. Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict. D. A branch or field of learning.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Economics** with **Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict**.

A. Interdisciplinary approach B. Political psychology C. Psychology D. Economics

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict** with **Economics**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Sociology**?

A. Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture. B. studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography. C. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy. D. Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sociology** with **Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture**.

A. Empirical approach B. Sociology C. Political philosophy D. Philosophy

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture** with **Sociology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Psychology**?

A. the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis. B. is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback. C. Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal. D. Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Psychology** with **Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.**

A. Normative approach B. History C. Political anthropology D. Psychology

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.** with **Psychology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Philosophy**?

A. Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life. B. Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure. C. is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes. D. Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Philosophy** with **Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.**

A. Political economy B. Philosophy C. Economics D. Law/jurisprudence as a data source

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.** with **Philosophy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political anthropology**?

A. political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context. B. (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest. C. political order does not require a Weberian state. D. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political anthropology** with **political order does not require a Weberian state..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political order does not require a Weberian state.**

A. Political sociology B. Sociology C. Political geography D. Political anthropology

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political order does not require a Weberian state.** with **Political anthropology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Law/jurisprudence as a data source**?

A. distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained. B. political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations. C. A branch or field of learning. D. Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Law/jurisprudence as a data source** with **distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained.**

A. Political psychology B. Law/jurisprudence as a data source C. Psychology D. Aristotle

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained.** with **Law/jurisprudence as a data source**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political geography**?

A. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy. B. Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved. C. studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography. D. Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political geography** with **studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.**

A. Political philosophy B. Philosophy C. Marx and Engels D. Political geography

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.** with **Political geography**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Aristotle**?

A. the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis. B. is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback. C. Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction. D. Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Aristotle** with **the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.**

A. History B. Aristotle C. Political anthropology D. Heinz Eulau

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.** with **Aristotle**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Marx and Engels**?

A. is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes. B. Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done. C. Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure. D. Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marx and Engels** with **Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure.**

A. Economics B. Law/jurisprudence as a data source C. Seymour Martin Lipset D. Marx and Engels

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure.** with **Marx and Engels**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Heinz Eulau**?

A. political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context. B. (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest. C. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making

and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions. D. Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Heinz Eulau** with **political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.**

A. Sociology B. Heinz Eulau C. Political geography D. Auguste Comte

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.** with **Heinz Eulau**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Seymour Martin Lipset**?

A. A branch or field of learning. B. Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought. C. political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations. D. Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Seymour Martin Lipset** with **political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations.**

A. Psychology B. Aristotle C. David Easton's political-system framework D. Seymour Martin Lipset

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations.** with **Seymour Martin Lipset**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Auguste Comte**?

A. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy. B. Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved. C. Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda. D. Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Auguste Comte** with **science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.**

A. Philosophy B. Auguste Comte C. Marx and Engels D. Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.** with **Auguste Comte**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **David Easton's political-system framework?**

A. Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction. B. Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems. C. is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback . D. Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **David Easton's political-system framework** with **is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback .** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback .**

A. Political anthropology B. Heinz Eulau C. Economic reductionism D. David Easton's political-system framework

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback .** with **David Easton's political-system framework**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model?**

A. is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes. B. Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done. C. Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation. D. political order does not require a Weberian state.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model** with **is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes.**

A. Law/jurisprudence as a data source B. Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model C. Seymour Martin Lipset D. Discipline

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes.** with **Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Economic reductionism**?

A. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions. B. Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict. C. (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest. D. distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Economic reductionism** with **(treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **(treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest.**

A. Political geography B. Auguste Comte C. Interdisciplinary approach D. Economic reductionism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **(treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest.** with **Economic reductionism.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ STATUS

No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this Political Theory topic. Political Theory is a conceptual-support repository, and the source mapping expressly prohibits proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ routing. The questions below are therefore labelled as original practice, not PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Define interdisciplinary political analysis and explain why borrowing must remain purposeful and politics-centred. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Interdisciplinary political analysis uses evidence, concepts or models from more than one discipline to investigate overlapping social phenomena.

Core analysis: Politics is embedded in economic, social, historical, psychological, legal and spatial environments. Political science therefore borrows when another discipline supplies evidence needed to explain a political question. History tests sequences, economics identifies material interests, sociology maps groups, psychology examines attitudes, and philosophy evaluates ends. Gauba's qualification is essential: labour relations, kinship or crowd behaviour enter political analysis only insofar as they illuminate power, authority, conflict, legitimacy or policy. Borrowing is purposeful when the political problem determines what is selected and how it is interpreted.

Critical evaluation: Random borrowing can produce an impressive list without explanation, while merger into a master science erases distinct questions and standards. Interdisciplinarity should widen verification and causal depth while keeping political judgment as the organising task.

Conclusion: Interdisciplinarity deepens political explanation only when borrowed evidence answers a clearly political question; random accumulation of neighbouring knowledge produces diffusion rather than integration.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Explain how history and economics contribute differently to political analysis. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: History and economics enrich political inquiry through different types of evidence and explanation.

Core analysis: History supplies sequences, antecedents, comparisons and long-term patterns. It tests whether claims about democracy, state formation or conflict survive variation across time and cases, but becomes mere chronicle if events are not politically interpreted. Economics examines production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and incentives. Political economy uses these mechanisms to explain class conflict, welfare choices, public control and how economic demands shape state decisions. It exposes material constraints that formal institutional analysis may overlook.

Critical evaluation: Neither discipline is sufficient alone. Historical recurrence does not establish present moral worth, and economic interest does not exhaust identity, legitimacy or obligation. Political analysis must interpret historical evidence and economic mechanisms through institutions, power relations and normative standards.

Conclusion: History tests political claims across time and sequence, while economics explains material incentives and distributional conflict; neither can independently settle legitimacy or justice.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Can political science be studied independently of the other social sciences? Discuss. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Political science has a distinct organising concern with power, authority, conflict and binding collective decisions, but its subject matter cannot be isolated from wider social life.

Core analysis: Gauba identifies three interdisciplinary functions: political science uses findings from related disciplines, verifies its theories through their evidence and contributes political insight back to them. History supplies temporal testing; economics explains resources and incentives; sociology identifies groups and institutions; psychology studies attitudes and leadership; philosophy clarifies values and ends. Behavioural and systems approaches intensified this exchange by shifting attention from formal government to actors and to the political system's environment. Yet borrowing does not abolish disciplinary identity, because the political question determines relevance.

Further development: The claim of autonomy must therefore be specified. Political science is autonomous in selecting and organising questions about collective power, but dependent in the evidential sense that those questions unfold through economies, social structures, personalities, histories and moral vocabularies. Interdisciplinary exchange is reciprocal rather than one-way: political institutions and decisions also reshape markets, identities and

behaviour. This avoids both disciplinary isolation and the opposite error of treating politics as merely an effect generated elsewhere.

Critical evaluation: A completely independent political science would become formally narrow or normatively abstract. Complete merger would be equally mistaken. The defensible position is autonomy through integration: a distinct political focus supported by multiple bodies of evidence.

Conclusion: Political science retains an autonomous organising question about power and authoritative allocation, but credible answers require evidence and models from the wider social sciences.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Examine the contributions and limits of sociology and psychology in political analysis. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Sociology and psychology correct institutional accounts by explaining the social structures and individual processes through which politics is lived.

Core analysis: Political sociology studies groups, status, norms, participation, leadership, political culture and the relation between social structures and political institutions. It explains why similar constitutional forms may operate differently across societies. Political psychology studies attitudes, learning, personality, propaganda, public opinion and charismatic or extremist appeal. It helps reconstruct how citizens and leaders perceive choices and acquire political orientations. Eulau's contextual account and Lipset's emphasis on mobilisation, values, kinship and class illustrate why behaviour cannot be detached from its environment.

Further development: Their explanatory levels can be connected through mechanisms. Social structures influence the identities, incentives and information available to actors; psychological processes shape how those conditions are perceived and acted upon; institutions then aggregate or constrain the resulting conduct. This sequence avoids simply listing variables. It also shows why neither approach can establish the legitimacy of an outcome: evaluation of domination, justice or responsibility requires political philosophy in addition to causal explanation.

Critical evaluation: Sociological reductionism may turn politics into passive maintenance of social structure, underplaying agency and deliberate institutional change. Psychological reductionism may individualise outcomes produced by class, law or organisation. The two disciplines contribute most when linked to each other and to political institutions.

Conclusion: Sociology and psychology reveal social structure and individual motivation respectively, but political explanation requires both levels to be connected to institutions, resources and normative judgment.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate the interdisciplinary approach to political analysis with reference to major disciplines and borrowed models. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Interdisciplinary political analysis responds to the fact that political action occurs within overlapping historical, economic, social, psychological and normative environments.

Core analysis: History verifies claims through sequences and cases; economics reveals scarcity, production and distribution; sociology explains groups, norms and participation; psychology studies attitudes, learning and leadership; philosophy clarifies obligation, justice and policy ends. Anthropology tests state-centred assumptions through non-state authority, law supplies formal texts and judicial reasoning, and geography reveals the territorial distribution of power and resources. Political science also borrows models: Easton's system comes from general systems thinking, structural-functionalism from sociology and anthropology, Lasswell's problem-solving orientation from psychology and decision theory, and base-superstructure analysis from political economy.

Further development: A full evaluation must distinguish data from models and explanation from evaluation. Literacy, income, kinship, attitudes, legal rules and regional distribution are data drawn from different disciplines; systems, structural-functional, market, elite and problem-solving frameworks organise causal interpretation. Philosophy then asks whether the resulting institutions and policies are justified. The approach is not automatically superior merely because it contains more variables. Explanations become incoherent when causal levels are mixed or evidence is imported without relevance. A strong interdisciplinary design therefore begins with a political question, identifies the missing evidence, specifies how each discipline changes the hypothesis and ends with an integrated rather than additive judgment.

Critical evaluation: Every borrowing carries reductionist risk. Material, social, psychological, legal or spatial variables can be mistaken for complete explanations. Gauba's remedy is integrated verification without merger and purposeful retention of the political question.

Conclusion: Interdisciplinary analysis is strongest as structured integration: multiple disciplines correct one another's blind spots while the political problem remains the organising centre.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Does interdisciplinarity deepen or threaten the autonomy of political science? Critically discuss. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Interdisciplinarity appears to threaten autonomy because political science borrows much of its evidence and many models from neighbouring disciplines.

Core analysis: The threat is real when economics reduces politics to bargaining or class, psychology to personality, sociology to system maintenance, law to formal rules, or geography to spatial destiny. A discipline that merely aggregates these accounts loses a distinct explanatory task. Yet political science asks a question none of them settles alone: how power, authority and conflict produce collectively binding decisions and how those decisions should be judged. History, economics, sociology, psychology, philosophy, anthropology, law and geography then become evidence routes organised around that problem. Borrowed models such as Easton's system or Lasswell's problem-solving framework remain political when adapted to political actors, institutions and consequences.

Further development: The Indian application can remain conceptual. Analysis of democratic durability may combine historical institution-building, economic inequality, caste or community structures, mass attitudes, constitutional law and territorial diversity. The 29 June 2026 release of MoSPI's SDG National Indicator Framework Progress Report offers a current evidence anchor because it organises time-series indicators across all seventeen SDGs for monitoring and policy. Such a framework illustrates interdisciplinary evidence, not a self-interpreting political conclusion. Indicator selection, distributional priorities, accountability and the meaning of development still require political and philosophical judgment. The example therefore supports autonomy through integration rather than government by data alone.

Critical evaluation: Autonomy therefore means control of the organising question, not insulation from evidence. Purposeful integration deepens political science; uncritical merger or single-discipline reduction threatens it.

Conclusion: Interdisciplinarity deepens rather than dissolves political science when borrowing is selective, reductionism is resisted and the discipline retains responsibility for political explanation and evaluation.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.